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Information Gathering & Reconnaissance Assignment

1. Executive Summary:

This report demonstrated the systematic and moral reconnaissance carried out against a legally permissible public Vulnerability Disclosure Program hosted on Hacker One. The Shopify program run by Shopify is the chosen target.

The only methods of reconnaissance that were allowed within the scope were used. Prioritizing passive data collection was followed, when permitted, by limited active scanning. There was no use of brute force or vulnerability scanning techniques.

The Objective of this assignment was to identify the attack surface and assess potential security risks without performing any intrusive or invasive actions.

2. Phase 0 – Scope Verification

a) Select ONE public VDP/Bug Bounty program (HackerOne, Bugcrowd, or Intigriti).

- The Selected public platform for this VDP or Bug bounty target assignment is Shopify e-commerce platform for all business which operates its security disclosure program through HackerOne

b) Include the program URL and copy the exact in-scope section in your report.

- HackerOne (2026) Shopify. Available at: <https://hackerone.com/shopify> (Accessed: 4 March 2026).

c) List in-scope assets and explicitly mention out-of-scope assets.

- *.shopify.com: The *.shopify.com search in the google shows all includes subdomain under shopify.com. For Example, help.shopify.com, cdn.shopify.com, changelog.shopify.com and hardware

i. [Help.shopify.com/shopify-admin](https://help.shopify.com/shopify-admin):



Shopify admin

Your Shopify admin is the central hub for managing all aspects of your store. The admin is a back-office tool for running your business' operations and logistics, as well as implementing your online design and marketing. It provides access to all the tools and features you need to run your business, including processing orders, managing products, analyzing sales data, and configuring store settings.

ii. cdn.shopify.com:



Shopify CDN

Shopify CDN refers to the content delivery Network used by shopify to delivery content fast and dynamic file transformation to users around the world.

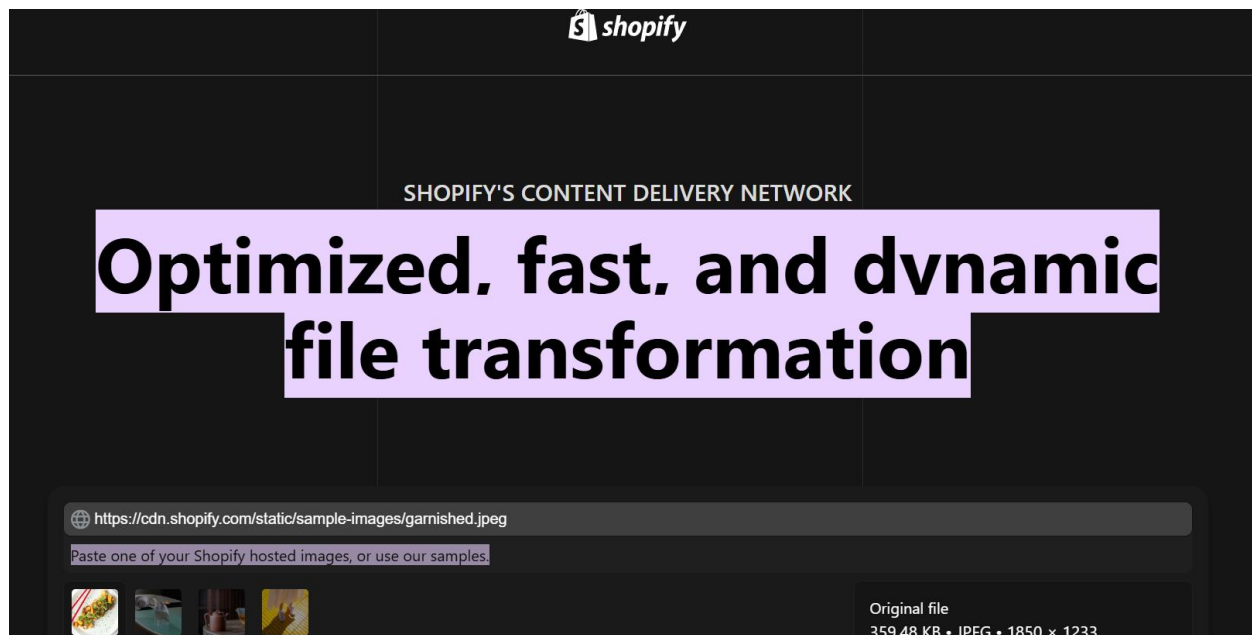


Figure 1: Shopify CDN

iii. changelog.shopify.com:



Shopify Changelog

Shopify changelog is a record of updates, improvements and fixes made to shopify's ecommerce platform, API and developer tools. The following changelog.shopify.com subdomain shows all the updates with time made by the shopify platform including sectors like Admin, Analytics, Apps, B2B, Marketing etc.

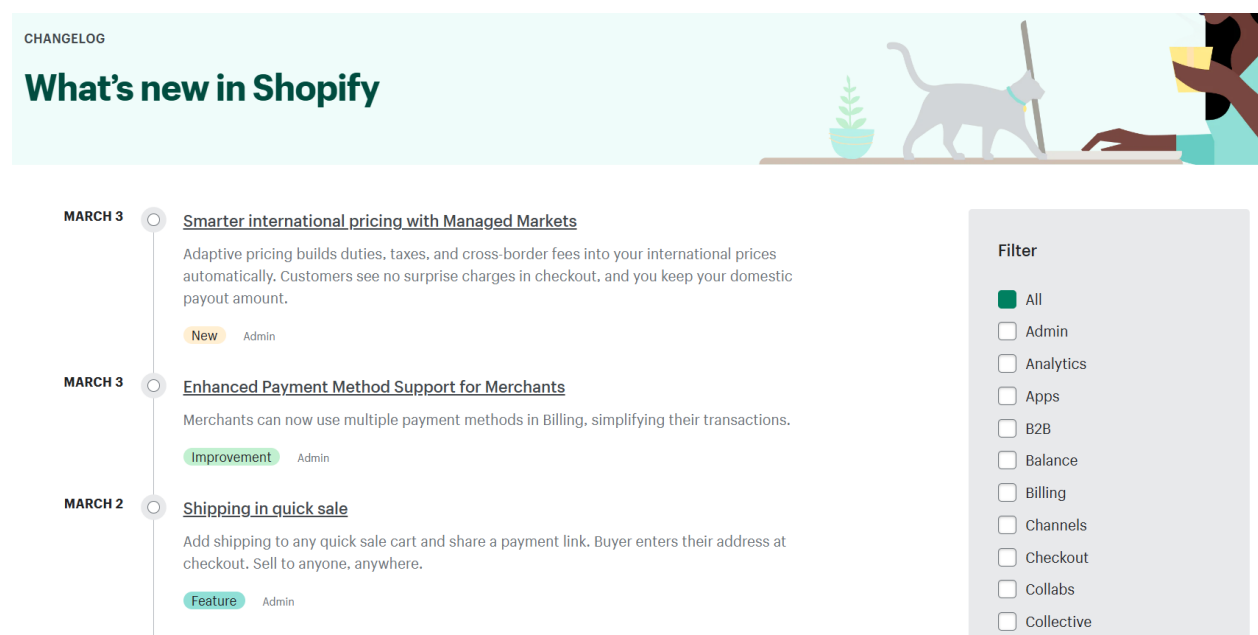


Figure 2: Shopify Changelog

iv. hardware.shopify.com



Shopify Hardware Store: Point of Sale Hardware - Shopify ...

Shopify hardware subdomain is a store that includes every POS hardware that you need for your retail store to accept cash and credit cards and to print receipts. Includes free shipping and a 30 days trials.

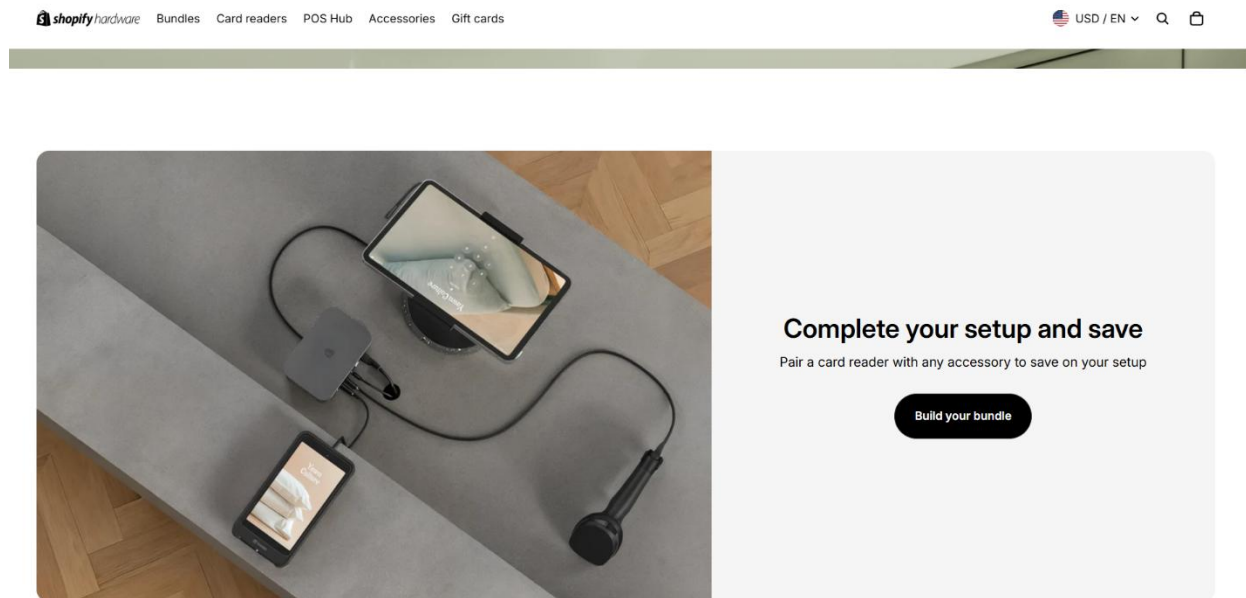


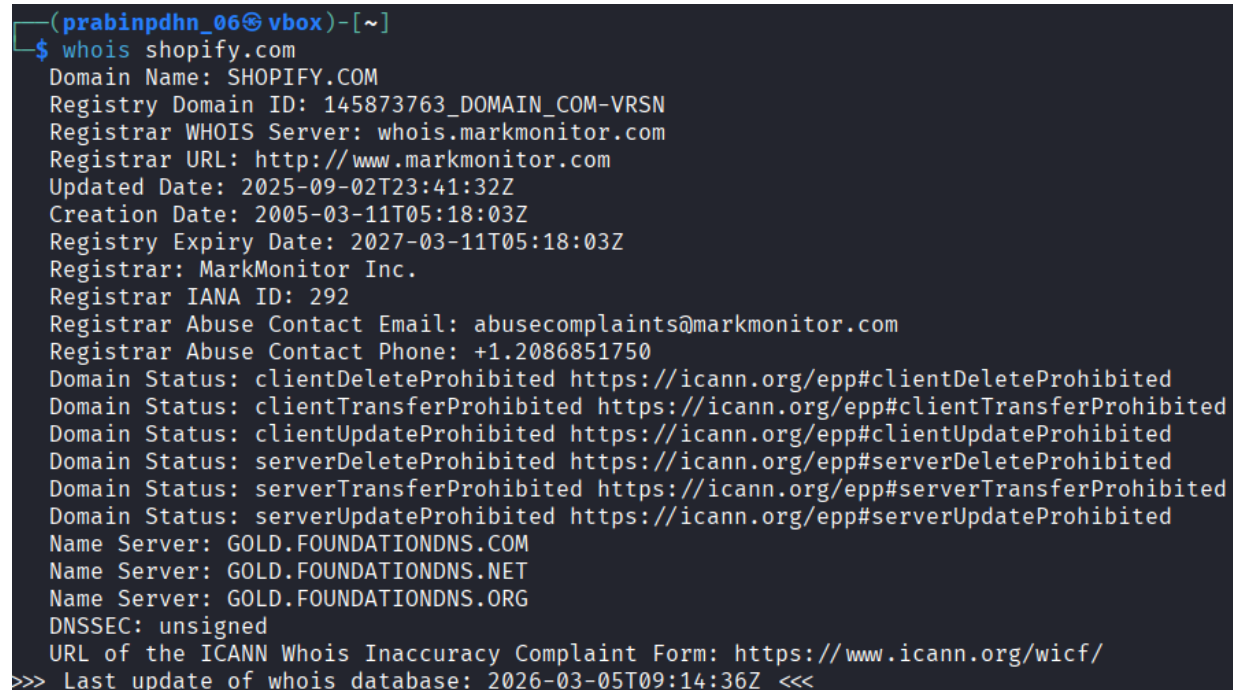
Figure 3: Shopify Hardware

d) Choose ONE domain strictly within scope.

- The domain shopify.com was selected for reconnaissance because it is explicitly listed as an in-scope asset in the bug bounty program hosted on HackerOne for Shopify.

2. Phase 1 – Passive Information Gathering

a) WHOIS (domain and IP if resolved).



```
(prabindhn_06@vbox)-[~]
$ whois shopify.com
Domain Name: SHOPIFY.COM
Registry Domain ID: 145873763_DOMAIN_COM-VRSN
Registrar WHOIS Server: whois.markmonitor.com
Registrar URL: http://www.markmonitor.com
Updated Date: 2025-09-02T23:41:32Z
Creation Date: 2005-03-11T05:18:03Z
Registry Expiry Date: 2027-03-11T05:18:03Z
Registrar: MarkMonitor Inc.
Registrar IANA ID: 292
Registrar Abuse Contact Email: abusecomplaints@markmonitor.com
Registrar Abuse Contact Phone: +1.2086851750
Domain Status: clientDeleteProhibited https://icann.org/epp#clientDeleteProhibited
Domain Status: clientTransferProhibited https://icann.org/epp#clientTransferProhibited
Domain Status: clientUpdateProhibited https://icann.org/epp#clientUpdateProhibited
Domain Status: serverDeleteProhibited https://icann.org/epp#serverDeleteProhibited
Domain Status: serverTransferProhibited https://icann.org/epp#serverTransferProhibited
Domain Status: serverUpdateProhibited https://icann.org/epp#serverUpdateProhibited
Name Server: GOLD.FOUNDATIONDNS.COM
Name Server: GOLD.FOUNDATIONDNS.NET
Name Server: GOLD.FOUNDATIONDNS.ORG
DNSSEC: unsigned
URL of the ICANN Whois Inaccuracy Complaint Form: https://www.icann.org/wicf/
>>> Last update of whois database: 2026-03-05T09:14:36Z <<<
```

Figure 4: WHOIS Shopify.com

The domain registration information for shopify.com is collected by using a whois query, as shown in the given Screenshots. From the obtained information we can identify domain ownership and infrastructure details.

- i. Domain Name: SHOPIFY.COM
- ii. Registry Domain ID: 145873763_DOMAIN_COM-VRSN
- iii. Registration Date: 2005-03-11T05:18:03Z
- iv. Registration Expiry Date: 2027-03-11T05:18:03Z
- v. Register URL: www.markmonitor.com
- vi. Server Name: GOLD.FOUNDATIONDNS.COM
GOLD.FOUNDATIONDNS.NET
GOLD.FOUNDATIONDNS.ORG

b) DNS and passive subdomain enumeration.

```
(prabindhn_06@vbox)-[~]  
$ dig shopify.com  
  
; <<>> DiG 9.20.11-4+b1-Debian <<>> shopify.com  
;; global options: +cmd  
;; Got answer:  
;; —>HEADER<— opcode: QUERY, status: NOERROR, id: 30001  
;; flags: qr rd ra; QUERY: 1, ANSWER: 1, AUTHORITY: 0, ADDITIONAL: 1  
  
;; OPT PSEUDOSECTION:  
; EDNS: version: 0, flags:; udp: 1232  
;; QUESTION SECTION:  
;shopify.com.                IN      A  
  
;; ANSWER SECTION:  
shopify.com.                20      IN      A      23.227.38.33  
  
;; Query time: 12 msec  
;; SERVER: 10.0.2.3#53(10.0.2.3) (UDP)  
;; WHEN: Wed Mar 04 20:32:24 MST 2026  
;; MSG SIZE  rcvd: 56
```

Figure 5: DNS and Subdomain enumeration

The DNS records were checked using dig command to identify domain infrastructure. DNS enumeration reveals how the domain is hosted and structured. From the obtained information we identify IP address, DNS records and Server IP.

i. IP Address: 23.227.38.33

ii. DNS Record: A Type

iii. Server IP: 10.0.2.3

c) robots.txt and sitemap analysis.

```

# robots.txt file for www.shopify.com
User-agent: GoogleDocs
Disallow: /

User-agent: AdIdxBot
Allow: */ppc/*
Allow: *utm_medium=cpc*

User-agent: Pinterestbot
Allow: */ppc/*
Allow: *utm_medium=cpc*

User-agent: AdsBot-Google-Mobile
Allow: */ppc/*
Allow: *utm_medium=cpc*

User-agent: AdsBot-Google
Allow: */ppc/*
Allow: *utm_medium=cpc*

User-agent: *
Disallow: *.data$
Disallow: */account
Disallow: */auth/callback
Disallow: */authenticate
Disallow: */authentication
Disallow: */editor$
Disallow: */finalize$
Disallow: */loading$
Disallow: */onboarding$
Disallow: */ppc/*
Disallow: */result$
Disallow: */services/identity/login
Disallow: */services/sa-appointments/login
Disallow: */services/sa-appointments/redirect
Disallow: */stock-photos/*?*page=*?*page=*
Disallow: */stock-photos/*?link_search=
Disallow: */stock-photos/*?q=
Disallow: */stock-photos/@*
Disallow: */stock-photos/admin
Disallow: */stock-photos/photos/search$
Disallow: */stock-photos/photos/search?
Disallow: */store/account
Disallow: */store/admin
Disallow: */store/cart
Disallow: */store/carts
Disallow: */store/checkout
Disallow: */store/checkouts/
Disallow: */store/orders
Disallow: */tools/*/*show*
Disallow: /*?flags=*
Disallow: *country=*

Disallow: *itcat=*
Disallow: *itterm=*
Disallow: *lang=*
Disallow: *link_search=*
Disallow: *page=*
Disallow: *prev_msid=*
Disallow: *utm_medium=cpc*
Disallow: /*/*?*shpxid=*
Disallow: /*/*?services*
Disallow: /*/*digital_wallets/dialog
Disallow: /*/admin/
Disallow: /*/apple-app-site-association
Disallow: /*/blog-article-remove-faq-utms-*.js
Disallow: /*/blog.atom
Disallow: /*/blog/search$
Disallow: /*/blog/search?
Disallow: /*/blogs/blog.atom
Disallow: /*/blogs/technology.atom
Disallow: /*/blogsearch$
Disallow: /*/cannabis
Disallow: /*/cdn-cgi/challenge-platform*
Disallow: /*/email-validation
Disallow: /*/enterprise/blog/search$
Disallow: /*/enterprise/blog/search?
Disallow: /*/growth-tools-assets
Disallow: /*/landing/
Disallow: /*/retail/search$
Disallow: /*/retail/search?
Disallow: /*/step/
Disallow: /*/submit
Disallow: /*/submitted
Disallow: /*/technology.atom
Disallow: /*/technology/tagged/*page*
Disallow: /*/tools/business-name-generator/searchbutton*
Disallow: /*/tools/business-name-generator/searchpage*
Disallow: /*/tools/business-name-generator/searchutf8*
Disallow: /*/ventureone
Disallow: /*CampaignId*
Disallow: /*hashid=%subscriber_hash%
Disallow: /*hubs_content*
Disallow: /.s/assets/shopifycloud/collabs-community-widge
Disallow: /.well-known/traffic-advice
Disallow: /500
Disallow: /__dux
Disallow: /__manifest
Disallow: /__pb/mm
Disallow: /__pb/rp
Disallow: /__pb/rr
Disallow: /authenticate
Disallow: /blog-article-remove-faq-utms-*.js
Disallow: /blog/search$
Disallow: /blog/search?

```

Figure 6: Shopify.com/robots.txt

The www.shopify.com/robots.txt is a plain text file located in the root of a shopify website. It tells search engine crawlers and other automated bots which parts of site they are allowed or disallowed to access. From this file we can identify restricted directories sensitive and internal pages.

This XML file does not appear to have any style information associated with it. The document tree is shown below.

```
<?xmlset xmlns="http://www.sitemaps.org/schemas/sitemap/0.9" xmlns:xhtml="http://www.w3.org/1999/xhtml" xmlns:video="http://www.google.com/schemas/sitemap-video/1.1">
  <url>
    <loc>https://www.shopify.com/</loc>
    <lastmod>2026-03-05</lastmod>
    <changefreq>daily</changefreq>
    <priority>1.0</priority>
  </url>
  <url>
    <loc>https://www.shopify.com/1mbb</loc>
    <lastmod>2026-03-05</lastmod>
    <changefreq>daily</changefreq>
    <priority>0.8</priority>
  </url>
  <url>
    <loc>https://www.shopify.com/404-static</loc>
    <lastmod>2026-03-05</lastmod>
    <changefreq>daily</changefreq>
    <priority>0.8</priority>
  </url>
  <url>
    <loc>https://www.shopify.com/about</loc>
    <lastmod>2026-03-05</lastmod>
    <changefreq>daily</changefreq>
    <priority>0.8</priority>
  </url>
  <url>
    <loc>https://www.shopify.com/accessibility</loc>
    <lastmod>2026-03-05</lastmod>
    <changefreq>daily</changefreq>
    <priority>0.8</priority>
  </url>
  <url>
    <loc>https://www.shopify.com/accessibility/plan</loc>
    <lastmod>2026-03-05</lastmod>
    <changefreq>daily</changefreq>
    <priority>0.8</priority>
  </url>
  <url>
    <loc>https://www.shopify.com/accessibility/policy</loc>
    <lastmod>2026-03-05</lastmod>
    <changefreq>daily</changefreq>
    <priority>0.8</priority>
  </url>
  <url>
    <loc>https://www.shopify.com/accessibility/vpat-admin</loc>
    <lastmod>2026-03-05</lastmod>
    <changefreq>daily</changefreq>
    <priority>0.8</priority>
  </url>
```

Figure 7: Shopify.com/sitemap.xml

The www.shopify.com/sitemap.xml is a list all URLs of shopify websites that should be indexed by search engines. It reveals the structure of a site, hidden pages or unlinked content that could be targets for testing or any web attack. From the obtained file information, we can identity different URL of shopify such as about page, accessibility page, product page, amazon pay etc.

d) Technology fingerprinting (Wappalyzer / WhatWeb).

```

(prabindphn_06@vbox)-[~]
$ whatweb shopify.com
http://shopify.com [301 Moved Permanently] Country[CANADA][CA], HTTPServer[cloudflare], IP[23.227.38.33], RedirectLocation[https://www.shopify.com/], Title[301 Moved Permanently], UncommonH
eaders[report-to,nel,server-timing,x-content-type-options,x-permitted-cross-domain-policies,x-download-options,x-shopid,cf-ray,alt-svc], X-XSS-Protection[1; mode=block]
https://shopify.com [301 Moved Permanently] Country[CANADA][CA], HTTPServer[cloudflare], IP[23.227.38.33], RedirectLocation[https://www.shopify.com/], Title[301 Moved Permanently], Uncommon
Headers[report-to,nel,server-timing,x-content-type-options,x-permitted-cross-domain-policies,x-download-options,x-shopid,cf-ray,alt-svc], X-XSS-Protection[1; mode=block]

https://www.shopify.com/ [200 OK] Cookies[_shopify_essential_,_shopify_s_,_shopify_y_], Country[RESERVED][22], Email[monique@email.com], HTML5, HTTPServer[cloudflare], IP[172.64.145.93], Open
-Graph-Protocol[website][847460188612391], PoweredBy[the], Script[application/ld+json,module,text/javascript], Strict-Transport-Security[max-age=15552000; includeSubDomains; preload], Title
[Shopify: The All-in-One Commerce Platform for Businesses - Shopify], UncommonHeaders[cf-ray,cf-cache-status,server-timing,x-content-type-options,report-to,nel,alt-svc]

```

Figure 8:Shopify Fingerprinting

The sensitive information and technology of shopify are collected by using whatweb commands. From the obtained information we can identify such as based country, web server, IP Address, framework and security headers.

- i. Web Server: Cloudflare
- ii. Country: Canada
- iii. Cloudflare IP Address: 23.227.38.33
- iv. Framework: Script[application/ld+json,module,text/javascript]
- v. Security header: X-XSS-Protection [1; mode=block]

e) Wayback Machine review.

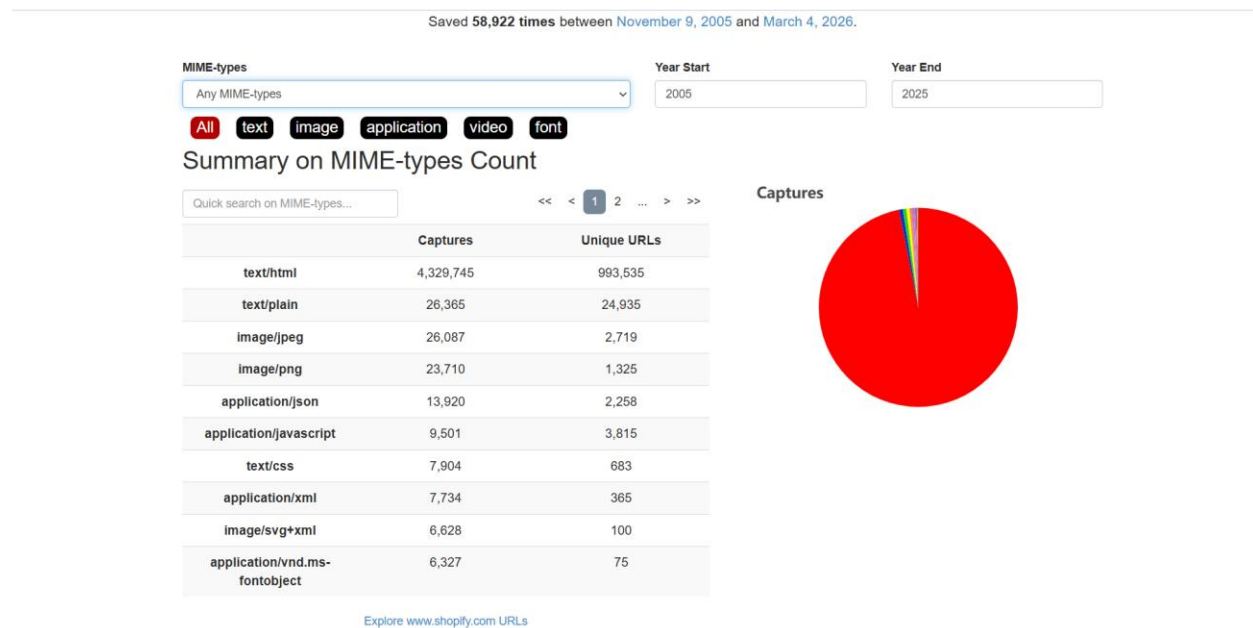


Figure 9: Shopify MIME types

The following table shows the types of files captured of shopify website along with captures and unique URL. The period ranges from November 9, 2005 to March 4, 2026

Captures: Total number of times that files type was archived.

Uniques URL: Number of different URLs containing that file type.

From the table:

Text/html: 4,329,745 captures and 993,535 unique URLs. This represents standard webpage HTML files, which make up the majority of the website.

Text/plain: 26365 captures, usually plain text files.

Image/jpeg and **image/png:** images used on the website.

Application/json: Data used by API or dynamic web services.

Application/javascript: JavaScript files used for website functionality.

Text/css: CSS files responsible for website styling.

Application/xml: Commonly used for sitemap or structured data.

Image/svg+xml: Vector graphics used in the interface.

Application/vnd.ms-fontobject: Font files used for web typography.

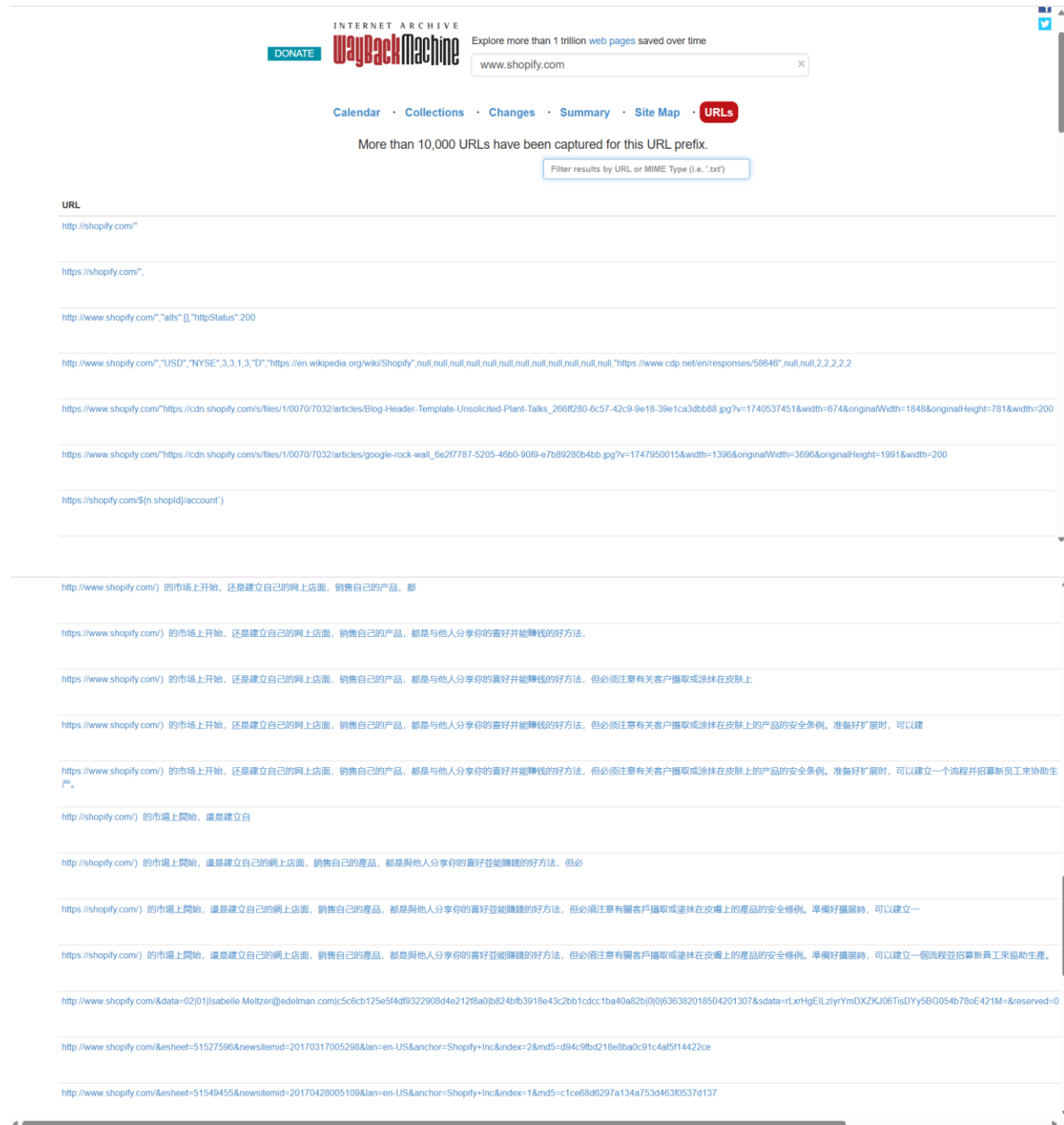


Figure 10: Shopify URL Captures

It period ranges from November 9, 2005 to March 4, 2026. The www.shopify.com path of websites has more than different **10,000 URLs** captured by www.web.archive.org, But it does not display all of them at once due to the large number of result. It discovers old,

latest pages of the website and found removed and hidden URLs. It contains thousands of blog article and Chinese URLs of the shopify website.

f) Email harvesting (theHarvester – passive sources only).

```
(prabinpdhn_06@vbox)-[~]
$ theHarvester -d shopify.com -b duckduckgo
Read proxies.yaml from /etc/theHarvester/proxies.yaml
*****
*                                     *
* | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | *
* | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | *
* | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | *
* | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | _ | *
*                                     *
* theHarvester 4.8.2                  *
* Coded by Christian Martorella       *
* Edge-Security Research              *
* cmartorella@edge-security.com       *
*                                     *
*****

[*] Target: shopify.com

[*] Searching Duckduckgo.

[*] No IPs found.

[*] No emails found.

[*] No people found.

[*] Hosts found: 13
-----
2Fapps.shopify.com
2Fhelp.shopify.com
2Fnews.shopify.com
admin.shopify.com
apps.shopify.com
cdn.shopify.com
changelog.shopify.com
community.shopify.com
gtm.shopify.com
help.shopify.com
news.shopify.com
privacy.shopify.com
themes.shopify.com
```

Figure 11: Shopify Harvesting

The theHarvester -d shopify.com -b duckduckgo commands is used for public available email address related to the shopify domain. From the obtained information we can only identify the subdomain of the shopify. Some of them are listed below:

2Fapps.shopify.com

2Fhelp.shopify.com

2Fnews.shopify.com

Privacy.shopify.com

g) Google dorking (site:, filetype:, intitle:, inurl:, wildcard subdomains).

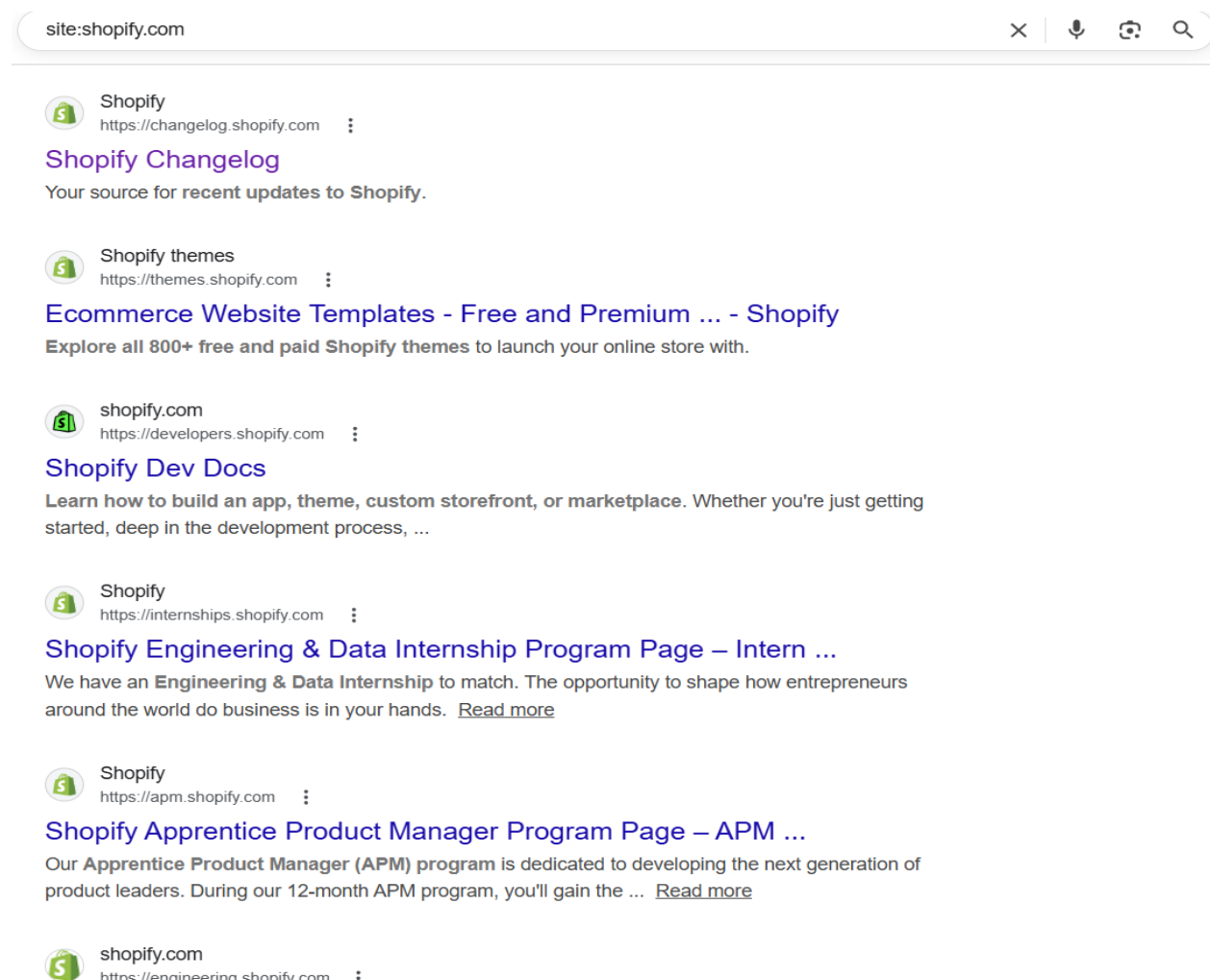


Figure 12: Site: Shopify.com

The site: operator search result only from a specific domain. The search site: shopify.com search shows only page that belong with that specific shopify domain. It used for identifying webpages and discover and subpages, directories.

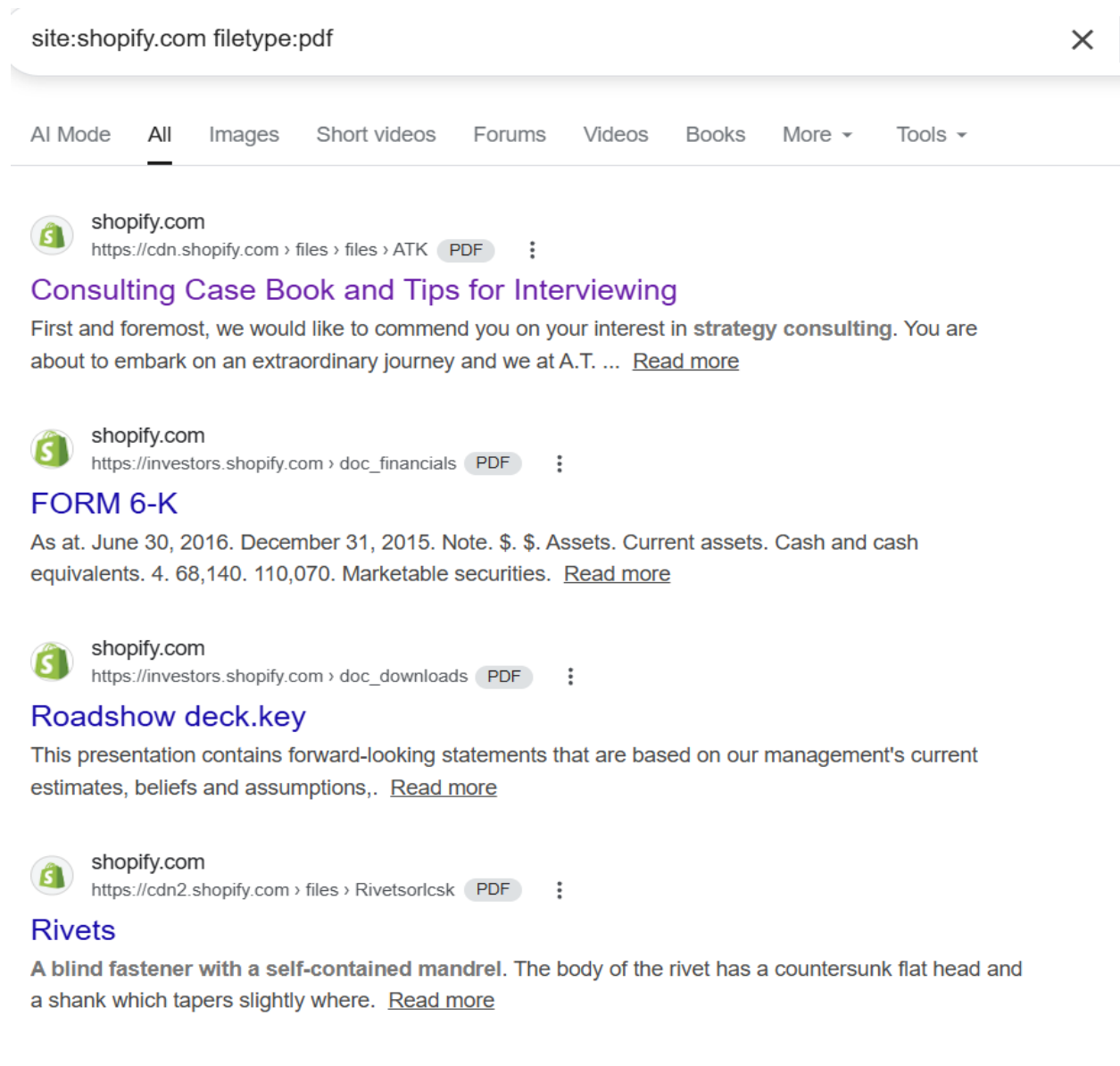


Figure 13: Site:Shopify.com filetype:pdf

The filetype: operator finds specific file formats on a website. The search site: shopify.com filetype:pdf search shows pdf files hosted on Shopify. From the obtained search, we can access helpful pdf provided by shopify.com.

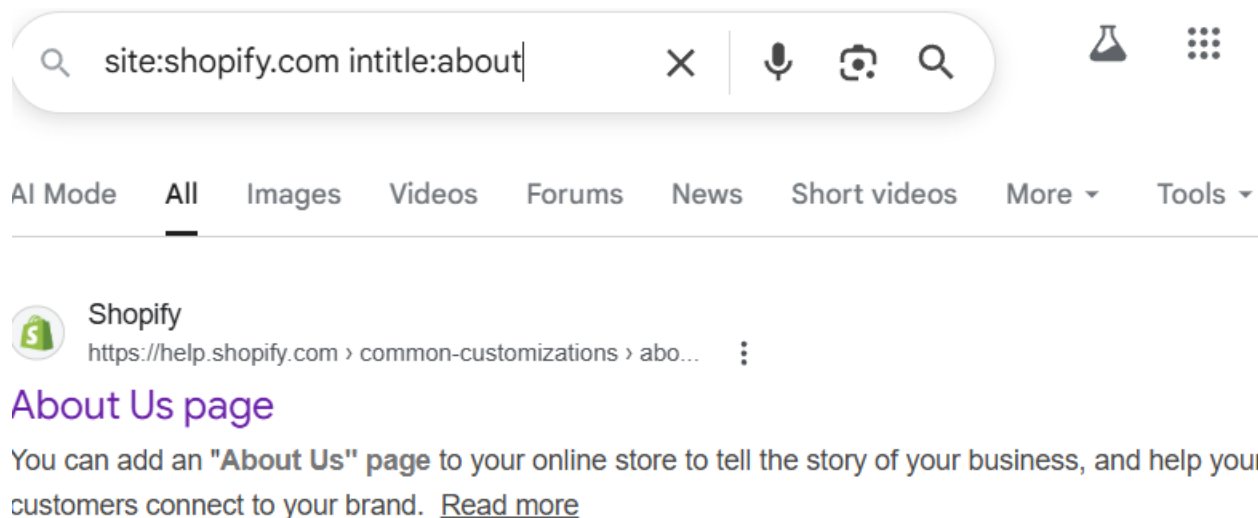


Figure 14: Site:Shopify.com intitle:about

The intitle: operator searches for words in the title of webpage. The search site: shopify.com intitle:about shows shopify pages that contain "About us" in the page title. It is used for identifying about us page of the shopify.

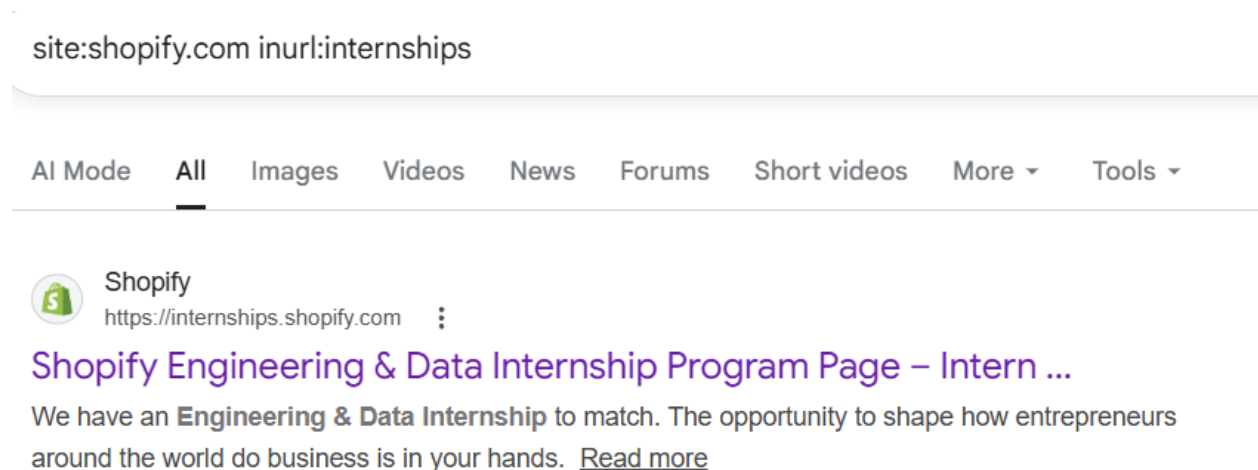


Figure 15: Site.Shopify.com inurl:internships

The inurl helps to find pages that contain specific words in their website URL. The search site: shopify.com inurl:internships reveal internship opportunities such as Data Engineer Intern, Infrastructure Engineer Intern, Security Engineer Intern and Software Engineer Intern roles offered by the Shopify platform.

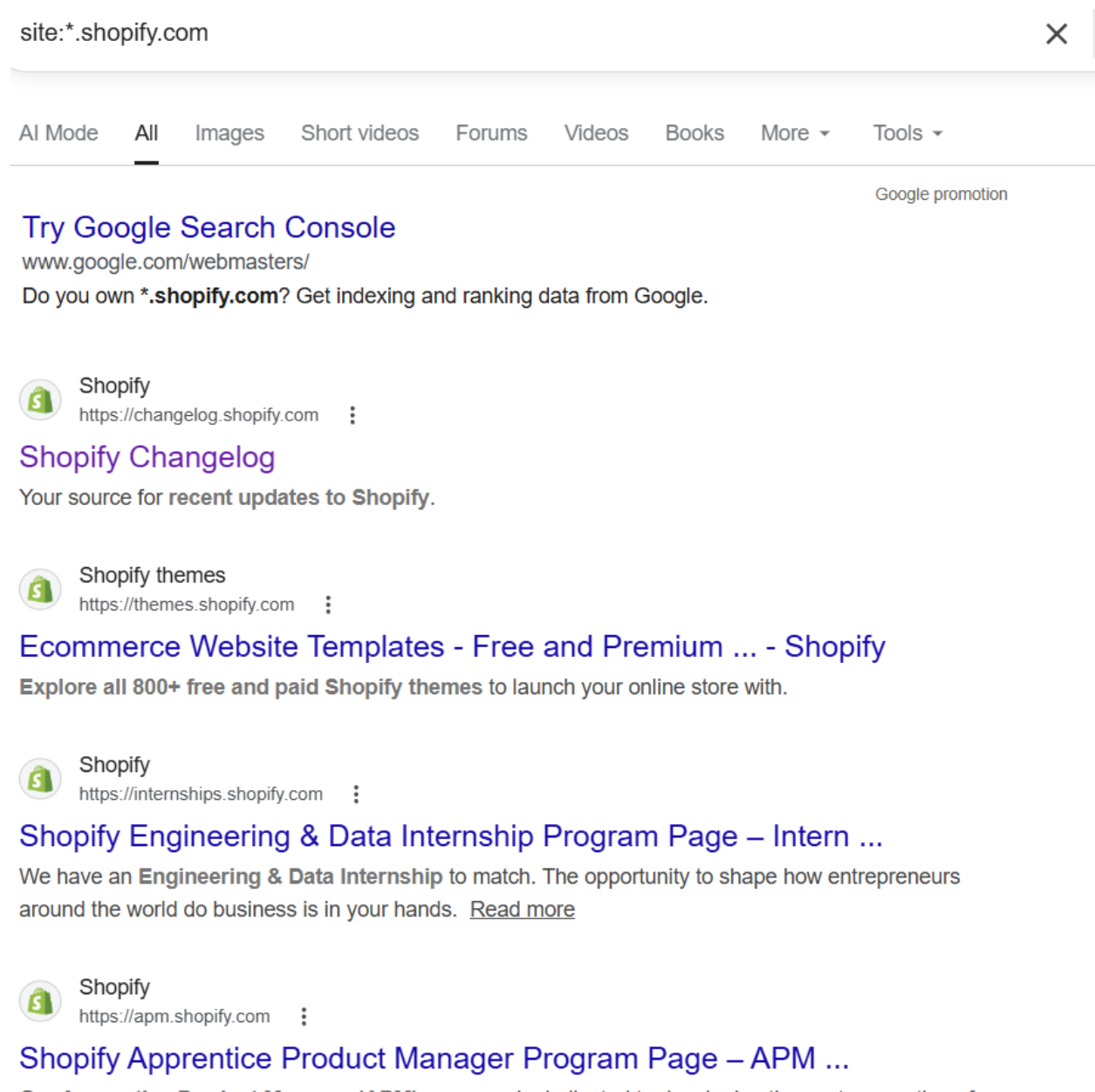


Figure 16: Site: *.Shopify.com

The site: * operator help to discover subdomains of specific domain search. The site: *.shopify.com finds pages from the different shopify subdomain. Some of the subdomains are listed below:

- i. Changelog.shopify.com
- ii. Themes.shopify.com
- iii. Internships.shopify.com

3. Phase 2 – Active Information Gathering

a) Host discovery (non-intrusive).

```
(prabinpdhn_06@vbox)-[~]
$ ping 23.227.38.33
PING 23.227.38.33 (23.227.38.33) 56(84) bytes of data.
64 bytes from 23.227.38.33: icmp_seq=1 ttl=255 time=11.8 ms
64 bytes from 23.227.38.33: icmp_seq=2 ttl=255 time=17.7 ms
64 bytes from 23.227.38.33: icmp_seq=3 ttl=255 time=14.0 ms
64 bytes from 23.227.38.33: icmp_seq=4 ttl=255 time=11.3 ms
64 bytes from 23.227.38.33: icmp_seq=5 ttl=255 time=12.6 ms
64 bytes from 23.227.38.33: icmp_seq=6 ttl=255 time=10.8 ms
64 bytes from 23.227.38.33: icmp_seq=7 ttl=255 time=12.1 ms
64 bytes from 23.227.38.33: icmp_seq=8 ttl=255 time=12.1 ms
64 bytes from 23.227.38.33: icmp_seq=9 ttl=255 time=16.9 ms
64 bytes from 23.227.38.33: icmp_seq=10 ttl=255 time=10.6 ms
64 bytes from 23.227.38.33: icmp_seq=11 ttl=255 time=10.8 ms
64 bytes from 23.227.38.33: icmp_seq=12 ttl=255 time=12.9 ms
64 bytes from 23.227.38.33: icmp_seq=13 ttl=255 time=11.6 ms
^C
— 23.227.38.33 ping statistics —
13 packets transmitted, 13 received, 0% packet loss, time 12606ms
rtt min/avg/max/mdev = 10.601/12.710/17.686/2.156 ms
```

Figure 17: Host Discovery

The host discovery from the Shopify Ip address was successful. The host is alive and replying to user.

b) Basic Nmap scanning and service/version detection.

```
(prabinpdhn_06@vbox)-[~]
$ nmap -sS shopify.com
Starting Nmap 7.95 ( https://nmap.org ) at 2026-03-05 01:50 MST
Nmap scan report for shopify.com (23.227.38.33)
Host is up (0.0080s latency).
rDNS record for 23.227.38.33: checkout.shopify.com
Not shown: 996 filtered tcp ports (no-response)
PORT      STATE SERVICE
80/tcp    open  http
443/tcp   open  https
8080/tcp  open  http-proxy
8443/tcp  open  https-alt
```

Figure 18: Port Scanning

The purpose of basic nmap **-sS** port scanning is to identify open ports of the Shopify.
The open ports state of the Shopify is such as 80, 443, 8080 and 8443.

```
(prabindhn_06@vbox)-[~]
$ nmap -sV shopify.com
Starting Nmap 7.95 ( https://nmap.org ) at 2026-03-05 02:01 MST
Nmap scan report for shopify.com (23.227.38.33)
Host is up (0.0083s latency).
rDNS record for 23.227.38.33: checkout.shopify.com
Not shown: 996 filtered tcp ports (no-response)
PORT      STATE SERVICE VERSION
80/tcp    open  http    Cloudflare http proxy
443/tcp   open  ssl/http Cloudflare http proxy
8080/tcp  open  http    Cloudflare http proxy
8443/tcp  open  ssl/http Cloudflare http proxy

Service detection performed. Please report any incorrect results at https://nmap.org/submit/ .
Nmap done: 1 IP address (1 host up) scanned in 17.49 seconds
```

Figure 19: Service Detection

The nmap command **-sV** shows that the open ports on Shopify are running Cloudflare services.

c) Operating system detection.

```
(prabindhn_06@vbox)-[~]
$ nmap -O shopify.com
Starting Nmap 7.95 ( https://nmap.org ) at 2026-03-05 02:13 MST
Nmap scan report for shopify.com (23.227.38.33)
Host is up (0.0069s latency).
rDNS record for 23.227.38.33: checkout.shopify.com
Not shown: 996 filtered tcp ports (no-response)
PORT      STATE SERVICE
80/tcp    open  http
443/tcp   open  https
8080/tcp  open  http-proxy
8443/tcp  open  https-alt
Warning: OSScan results may be unreliable because we could not find at least 1 open and 1 closed port
Device type: bridge|VoIP adapter|general purpose
Running (JUST GUESSING): Oracle Virtualbox (98%), Slirp (98%), AT&T embedded (95%), QEMU (94%)
OS CPE: cpe:/o:oracle:virtualbox cpe:/a:danny_gasparovski:slirp cpe:/a:qemu:qemu
Aggressive OS guesses: Oracle Virtualbox Slirp NAT bridge (98%), AT&T BGW210 voice gateway (95%), QEMU user mode network gateway (94%)
No exact OS matches for host (test conditions non-ideal).

OS detection performed. Please report any incorrect results at https://nmap.org/submit/ .
Nmap done: 1 IP address (1 host up) scanned in 9.14 seconds
```

Figure 20: OS System Detection

The nmap **-O** commands for the detecting OS system show 98% probability of Oracle VirtualBox Slirp, 95% probability of AT&T embedded and 94% probability of QEMU.

d) WAF detection.

```
(prabinpdhn_06@vbox)-[~]
$ wafw00f shopify.com

?      ?
(____)';   ???          .; ) '( (" " ;(. (( ( ;) " ") 
/,___/'    _". ,.-'-.),(..,(.')_-'') (' ..(' ') 
\\__\\     |_____|

               ~ WAFW00F : v2.3.1 ~
           ~ Sniffing Web Application Firewalls since 2014 ~

[*] Checking https://shopify.com
[+] The site https://shopify.com is behind Cloudflare (Cloudflare Inc.) WAF.
[~] Number of requests: 2
```

Figure 21: WAF Detection

The **wafw00f** commands detected Cloudflare Sniffing Web Application Firewalls (WAF) protecting the Shopify, since 2014. This shows malicious traffic in the Shopify is been filtered protected by the WAF.

e) DNS zone transfer attempt (if permitted).

```
(prabindhn_06@vbox)-[~]
$ host -l shopify.com ns1.shopify.com
;; Connection to 23.227.38.33(23.227.38.33) for shopify.com failed: timed out.
;; no servers could be reached
;; Connection to 23.227.38.33(23.227.38.33) for shopify.com failed: timed out.
;; no servers could be reached
```

Figure 22: DNS Transfer Attempt

The DNS zone transfer request for shopify.com is not respond by the server and Shopify DNS Server blocks unauthorized zone transfers with the message no servers could be reached.

4. Phase 3 – Analysis & Attack Surface Mapping

a) Asset inventory (domains, subdomains, technologies, IPs, open ports).

```
(prabindhn_06@vbox)-[~]
$ nslookup shopify.com
Server:          10.0.2.3
Address:         10.0.2.3#53

Non-authoritative answer:
Name:   shopify.com
Address: 23.227.38.33
```

```
(prabindhn_06@vbox)-[~]
$ subfinder -d shopify.com

projectdiscovery.io

[INF] Current subfinder version v2.6.0 (outdated)
[INF] Loading provider config from the default location: /home/prabindhn_06/.config/subfinder/provider-config.yaml
[INF] Enumerating subdomains for shopify.com

snapify.shopify.com
afterhours.shopify.com
50ae1a-3r.shopify.com
96.nat.ash.shopify.com
accnts.shopify.com
nexus.shopify.com
h.ssl.shopify.com
webinar-sept-30.shopify.com
23-227-38-31.shopify.com
4apps.shopify.com
exchange-help.shopify.com
toronto.shopify.com
stevenessus-test.ec2.shopify.com
tashboard.shopify.com
23-227-38-29.shopify.com
23-227-38-40.shopify.com
upcoming12.shopify.com
110.nat.ash.shopify.com
cdn.shopify.com
colourdecoded.shopify.com
sourcing-supplier.shopify.com
102.nat.ash.shopify.com
ec1.shopify.com
flwca.shopify.com
sugarpack.shopify.com
projectboard.shopify.com
tableau-dev.data.shopify.com
lifehacks.shopify.com
tmt.shopify.com
252fcdn.shopify.com
amazon.shopify.com
next.shopify.com
in.shopify.com
icinga.chi2.shopify.com
```

Figure 23: Finding Ip Address of domain and Shopify Subdomain sites

Domain: The nslookup command finds the ip address associated with the Shopify. From the given we obtained information such as Shopify Ip address 23.227.38.33 and server ip address 10.0.2.3

Subdomain: The subfinder -d shopify.com commands discovered 435 subdomains for shopify.com. The example of the detected such subdomains are:

i. Amazon.shopify.com

ii. Next.shopify.com

iii. In.shopify.com

iv. cdn.shopify.com

```
(prabindhn_06@vbox)-[~]
$ sudo nmap 23.227.38.33
[sudo] password for prabindhn_06:
Starting Nmap 7.95 ( https://nmap.org ) at 2026-03-05 03:57 MST
Nmap scan report for checkout.shopify.com (23.227.38.33)
Host is up (0.0064s latency).
Not shown: 996 filtered tcp ports (no-response)
PORT      STATE SERVICE
80/tcp    open  http
443/tcp   open  https
8080/tcp  open  http-proxy
8443/tcp  open  https-alt

Nmap done: 1 IP address (1 host up) scanned in 4.95 seconds
```

Figure 24: Port Scanning in the target IP Address

Open Ports: The sudo nmap command with the target ip address 23.227.38.33 shows open ports of service and open port includes 80 for http, 443 for https, 8080 for http-proxy and 8443 for https-alt.

Technology fingerprinting: The sensitive fingerprinting technologies of Shopify platform is various. Some of the important information that are listed below:

- i. Web Server: Cloudflare ii. Country: Canada
- iii. Cloudflare IP Address: 23.227.38.33
- iv. Framework: Script[application/ld+json,module,text/javascript]
- v. Security header: X-XSS-Protection [1; mode=block]

b) Identify potential attack surface areas.

Ans: The identified potential attack surface areas are:

Attack Surface Area	Details
Multiple subdomains:	Shopify Subdomains areas increase the number of entries points in the website that attacker can potentially target.
Open Web Ports:	Open web ports such as 80 and 443 allow public access to web service, which expands the external attack surface.
Wayback Machine Captured URLs	The wayback machine captured more than 10,000 URLs links including old blogs articles and thousands of Chinese URLs from the Shopify website. These links may contain any loopholes in the websites that attacker can potentially exploit.
Web Application Firewall (WAF)	The wafw00f command used to detect Web Application Firewall (WAF) identified Cloudflare WAF filtering malicious traffic and protecting web application. Attacker may still analyze how WAF works and find out possible bypass techniques.

c) Explain why findings may present risk.

Ans: From this reconnaissance phase, it is noted that there are exposed assets such as the domain, associated IP address, open web ports, and multiple subdomains. This indicates that ports such as 80 and 443 enable public access to web services, thus increasing the attack surface. Moreover, the presence of multiple subdomains could imply additional avenues that require security measures. Technology fingerprinting showed that Shopify utilizes a Content Delivery Network, denoted by a Cloudflare firewall, which provides security against common web-based attacks and helps to mask infrastructure. This indicates that attackers could target attempts to evade these security measures. DNS records such as an A record, which resolves to 23.227.38.33, confirm that the domain maps to a server. Poorly managed DNS records could imply additional attack surfaces such as subdomains. Additionally, historical data such as information obtained from the Wayback Machine and existing files such as robots.txt and sitemap.xml could imply accessible resources, which could be used by attackers during reconnaissance for potential vulnerabilities. It is noted that Shopify has robust security measures, but the identified attack surfaces require constant monitoring and security to ensure robust security.

5. Ethical Reflection:

This assignment was conducted under the context of Vulnerability Disclosure Program (VDP) / Bug Bounty Scope, which included reconnaissance and analysis of the Shopify platform. The activities conducted under this assignment were restricted to information gathering and attack surface analysis, ensuring that no exploitation, unauthorized access, or disruption of the service was conducted. All the activities conducted under this assignment adhered to the ethical norms of information security research, ensuring that the scope of the program, as defined on the HackerOne platform, was respected.

The main objective of this assignment was to understand the approach that security researchers, also known as ethical hackers, take to gather information that is available in the public domain to understand the risks, keeping the scope of the program in mind. Information gathering tools such as Nmap, theHarvester, WhatWeb, and wafw00f have been conducted for the purpose of analysis to understand the publicly available assets, technologies, and security controls, including CDN and WAF.

The ethical considerations were met through ensuring that the reconnaissance activities were non-intrusive and passive, and were conducted within the principles of responsible disclosure.

This shows the significance of understanding the boundaries set by the organization, the law, and the user when conducting cybersecurity research. The assignment shows the significance of ethical reconnaissance in helping organizations understand their external attack surface and also shows the responsibility that researchers have to operate within the boundaries set by the law.

6. Conclusion:

This assignment, which was based on a VDP (Vulnerability Disclosure Program) or Bug Bounty scenario, was focused on the Shopify e-commerce platform to undertake a structured information gathering and analysis exercise. The results of the passive reconnaissance included domain, subdomain, IP, DNS, and technology stack, including CDN and WAF. The results of the active information gathering included open ports, including 80, 443, 8080, and 8443, and the presence of a Cloudflare Web Application Firewall. The results of the attack surface mapping included potential exposure points, including web services and subdomains. The results of the reconnaissance also included historical information, including the results of using the Wayback Machine, which gave us insight into the history of Shopify's web pages and resources, which could still pose a potential risk if misconfigured.

The detection of WAF using wafw00f also identified the presence of Cloudflare, which has been confirmed by the historical analysis that has identified the presence of Web Application Firewall protection from 2014 onwards in Shopify. This has identified that, despite the presence of strong security controls in Shopify, it is imperative to understand the historical content, endpoints, and security controls in order to effectively map the attack surface of the application in the context of the Bug Bounty program.

Appendix:

The tools I used for this information gathering and reconnaissance assignment are listed below:

Tool	Purpose in Assignment
whois	Used to collected domain registration details such as register date, creation date, expiry date and owner information of Shopify.
nslookup	Used to resolve the Shopify domain to its ip address and Server ip address.
dig	Used to get advance details of DNS records A, MX, NS, TXT and resolve the domain to its ip address.
host	Used to perform DNS lookup and DNS Zone transfer in the Shopify.
ping	Used to check connectivity between user to Shopify server whether host is alive or not.
nmap	Used for host discovery, port scanning, service detection and operating system detection in the Shopify.
whatweb	Used for technology fingerprinting fo identify technologies used by the Shopify.
theHarvester	Used for passive email harvesting and gathering publicly available information from the shopify website.
Wafw00f	Used to detected Web Application Firewall protecting the Shopify website
Wayback Machine	Used to review archived version of the Shopify website and identify historical URLs and content.
Google search	Used for google dorking techniques like site:, inurl:, intitle:, filetype: to discover publicly indexed information of Shopify.